



PLANT-BASED CHEESE

Coconut Cheddar v3

COMMERCIALIZATION DECISION

GO

Approved for launch preparation · claims
evidence limited



DIRECTIONAL CONCEPT VISUAL

Internal review visual. Final external cover approval remains pending.

PREPARED FOR

New Food Innovation

REPORT DATE

June 12, 2026

VERSION / STATUS

Version 3 · review

DECISION AT A GLANCE

Overall sensory acceptance
(84/100) is the strongest
documented sensory result.

ISSF

82.4

DECISION MARGIN

+7.4 points

EVIDENCE

86/100

Premium product thinking, bounded by project evidence.

Executive recommendation

The decision, why it is supportable, and what leadership should authorize next.

RECOMMENDATION

Coconut Cheddar v3 is approved for launch preparation.

GO

Coconut Cheddar v3 has a confirmed GO recommendation. Acceptance supports moving the product into the next validation round.

ISSF

82.4

GO THRESHOLD

75

DECISION MARGIN / PTS

+7.4

EVIDENCE STRENGTH

86/100

PROTECT

Overall sensory acceptance (84/100) is the strongest documented sensory result.

WATCH

Concept evidence is directional only; consumer and market claims require broader validation.

What this means by audience

EXECUTIVE

Authorize controlled launch preparation and the named validation work. Do not authorize consumer, demand, price, packaging-preference, nutrition, health, or superiority claims at this stage.

R&D

Proceed with launch preparation. Confirm pilot-scale product performance, then build the claim-ready launch story through target-consumer validation, packaging approval, and claims/legal review.

MARKETING

Build the story around supported product strengths. Consumer preference, demand, price acceptance, packaging preference, and purchase intent remain validation work until approved.

Immediate priorities

- 01 Pilot manufacturing and product confirmation
- 02 Consumer, competition, price, and commercial economics
- 03 Packaging, regulatory, claims, and launch approval

Product performance

Sensory results, instrumental context, and literature-guided interpretation of the tested product.

Deterministic sensory decision factors

Readiness line 60/100

Overall sensory acceptance

Sensory screening result

84/100

Acceptance supports moving the product into the next validation round.

Texture performance

Sensory screening result

68/100

Texture is viable but should be monitored through scale-up.

Sensory descriptor profile

Sensory screening result

81/100

The sensory profile is recognizable and category-relevant.

Positive emotional response indicators

Sensory screening result

77/100

Positive response supports the direction, but remains secondary evidence.

INSTRUMENTAL CONTEXT

No project dataset attached

No project instrumental dataset is attached to this saved report version.

LITERATURE STRENGTHENS THE NEXT STUDY

Texture and mouthfeel confirmation

Keep texture and mouthfeel measures in the pilot confirmation plan because structure strongly shapes the plant-based cheese experience.

Sources: [L1]

STUDY BASIS AND DEFINITIONS

Study basis: sensory screening plus concept test n=24. Scores are shown on a 0–100 scale. Evidence caveat: variability and agreement statistics were not included in this report snapshot and should be added to the next validation round.

Consumer and concept response

The working proposition, observed response, evidence boundary, and commercial implication.

WORKING PROPOSITION

Everyday Melt

Coconut Cheddar v3 is a familiar plant-based cheese proposition built around the strongest validated sensory cues.

PRIORITY CONSUMER

Flexitarian households seeking an easy dairy swap without sacrificing familiar flavor



RESPONSES

n=24

EVIDENCE STRENGTH

Developing

PURCHASE INTENT

6.8

Observed response



PRODUCT PROMISE

A credible plant-based cheese option that feels familiar and easy to use.

PRICE HYPOTHESIS

Test \$5.99 per 7 oz pack against category alternatives.

COMMERCIAL MEANING

Commercial development can continue, but investment approval requires a validated consumer case, competitive and price evidence, unit economics, a defined channel, and a documented launch forecast.

CONCEPT EVIDENCE BOUNDARY

Concept test n=24. Concept evidence is based on 24 panelist responses. Treat preference and purchase-intent findings as directional until a broader panel is collected.

Panel and study profile

Who contributed, profile coverage, privacy rules, and the representativeness boundary.

SENSORY EVIDENCE

Sensory panel size not documented

CONCEPT EVIDENCE

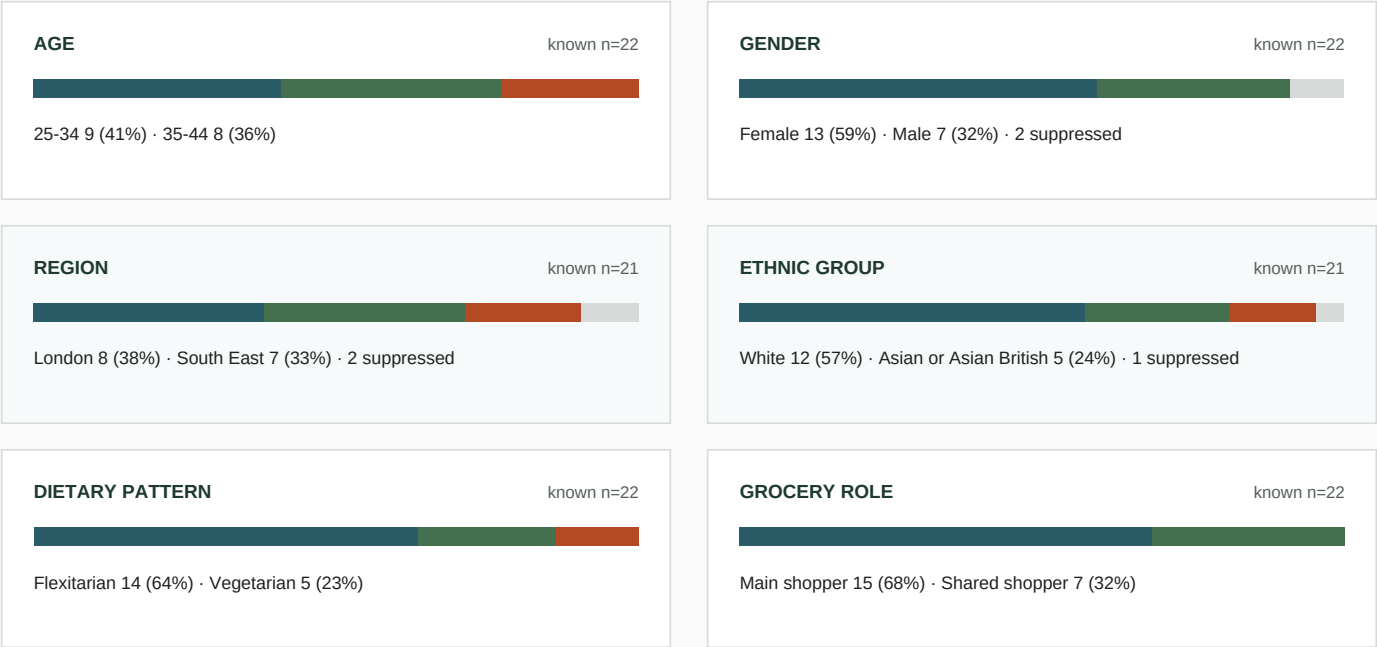
Concept respondents n=24

PROFILE COVERAGE

22/24 respondent profiles (92%)

Respondent demographic profile

Percentages use known responses within each demographic field.



Scientific literature and evidence map

How approved literature informs interpretation, validation design, and evidence limits.

WHAT LITERATURE CONTRIBUTES Mechanistic context, category benchmarks, method choices, and stronger validation design.	WHAT LITERATURE CANNOT PROVE This product's performance, consumer preference, demand, price acceptance, or superiority.
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Approved source register

2 sources attached

[L1] Texture drivers in plant-based cheese alternatives Author and year metadata not captured DOI not captured	STUDY TYPE Classification unavailable	EVIDENCE ROLE Method context
[L2] Consumer acceptance of plant-based foods Author and year metadata not captured DOI not captured	STUDY TYPE Category study	EVIDENCE ROLE Category and consumer context

How the literature changes the next study

01 Texture and mouthfeel confirmation Keep texture and mouthfeel measures in the pilot confirmation plan because structure strongly shapes the plant-based cheese experience.	[L1]
02 Target-consumer validation Benchmark the correct product format and confirm positioning and usage cues with the intended consumer group.	[L2]

Recommended action plan

Three controlled workstreams convert the product decision into release-ready evidence.

PROTECT

1

Pilot manufacturing and product confirmation

WHY / PROTOCOL

Confirm repeatability and sensory consistency after scale-up. Run representative pilot batches; repeat the critical sensory and instrumental measures; confirm process settings, yield, variability, and finished-product

PASSING EVIDENCE

Approved pilot-batch record and QC report. Pass: Agreed sensory, quality, yield, and process criteria pass on representative pilot batches.

OWNER / GATE

Owner: Product + Quality. Timing: Next pilot cycle. Next gate: Pilot validation.

IMPROVE

2

Consumer, competition, price, and commercial economics

WHY / PROTOCOL

Market proof and economics remain unvalidated. Run a powered target-consumer study; benchmark alternatives; test proposition and price; model product, pack, logistics, margin, trade spend, and launch investment.

PASSING EVIDENCE

Consumer dataset, benchmark, price architecture, and approved economics model. Pass: Concept n>=30 with documented panel fit; approved benchmark, price, margin, and launch scenarios.

OWNER / GATE

Owner: Insights + Commercial. Timing: Before buyer review. Next gate: Investment review.

VALIDATE

3

Packaging, regulatory, claims, and launch approval

WHY / PROTOCOL

The final pack and external statements require approval. Validate pack and line performance; approve ingredients, allergens, nutrition, naming, labeling, and claims; complete launch review.

PASSING EVIDENCE

Approved pack, line trial, label, claims matrix, and launch record. Pass: Pack tests pass; regulatory, legal, quality, and commercial approve release.

OWNER / GATE

Owner: Packaging + Regulatory. Timing: Before external release. Next gate: Launch approval.

NEXT DECISION GATE

Move from launch preparation to launch execution only after pilot approval, commercial investment review, and packaging/regulatory launch approval.

LEAD CONTROLLED RISK

Reduce late-stage gumminess and confirm melt performance after pilot-scale processing. Control: Set pilot-scale acceptance ranges and repeat the critical sensory measures.

Evidence and release record

Every material statement is bounded by its project evidence, limitations, approved literature, and release status.

Claim-to-evidence register

CLAIM / STATUS	EVIDENCE	PERMITTED WORDING / REQUIREMENT
E1 / SUPPORTED Product advancement decision INTERNAL DECISION STATEMENT	GO at ISSF 82.4; Sensory panel size not documented.	Approved to proceed into launch preparation. Requirement: Limited to the tested product and study conditions.
E2 / SUPPORTED Tested sensory results INTERNAL DECISION STATEMENT	Acceptance 84/100; texture 68/100.	Report the measured results with sample size and study basis. Requirement: Repeat at pilot scale before production-performance claims.
E3 / BLOCKED Consumer demand, price, and purchase intent EXTERNAL CLAIM	Concept and purchase-intent observations exist at n=24; market and price representativeness are not established.	No external demand, price-acceptance, or purchase-intent wording. Requirement: Complete target-consumer validation at n>=30 with documented panel fit. Use a realistic price and pack stimulus.
E4 / BLOCKED Packaging preference EXTERNAL CLAIM	The selected visual is a directional concept stimulus, not approved final artwork.	Directional packaging hypothesis for research use only. Requirement: Complete packaging validation, design approval, and legal review.
E5 / BLOCKED Nutrition, health, or superiority benefits EXTERNAL CLAIM	No claim-specific substantiation is included in this report.	None until substantiated and approved. Requirement: Create a claim-specific evidence file and obtain legal approval.

APPROVED LITERATURE GUIDANCE

References used for context and study design

[L1] Texture drivers in plant-based cheese alternatives. DOI not captured

[L2] Consumer acceptance of plant-based foods. DOI not captured

MATERIAL LIMITATIONS

Concept evidence is below the n>=30 operational threshold (current n=24). External claims require claim-specific substantiation and approval.

EVIDENCE POPULATIONS

Sensory evidence: Sample size not captured (Saved sensory study). Concept evidence: n=24 (Directional only). Instrumental evidence: Not attached (Context only or unavailable).

RELEASE DECISION / DRAFT FOR REVIEW

External distribution is pending report approval. No external marketing claim is authorized until its specific evidence and approval requirement is complete.

Evidence register version 3 · Working report version. Cross-functional approval is required before external distribution.